NOMINALIZACIÓN

Nivel C2

Nominalisation · estilo académico

Convertir verbos y adjetivos en sustantivos da al texto densidad, objetividad y tono académico.

1 ¿Qué es?

- analyse → analysis
- fail → failure
- accurate → accuracy

Acción o cualidad → sustantivo: más densidad y registro formal.

2 Sufijos clave

-tion · -ment · -ance · -ence · -al · -ity · -ness · -ure · -sis

Sin sufijo (conversión): an increase, a decline, a review.

3 Oración → frase nominal

- because the economy grew → owing to economic growth
- they analysed the data → the analysis of the data
- adverbio → adjetivo: grew rapidly → rapid growth

4 Colocaciones formales

- carry out an investigation · conduct research
- reach a conclusion · pose a threat
- make a contribution · draw a distinction

5 Causa y efecto

- Causa: owing to, due to, in view of
- Efecto: lead to, result in, give rise to
- Rising costs led to the closure of the plant.

7 Error común

✗ They realised a study on poverty.

✓ They carried out a study on poverty.

realizar → carry out / conduct · realise = darse cuenta

6 Consejo de registro

- Informal → verbos · académico → sustantivos.
- No abuses: evita los zombie nouns.
- ~~make an assessment of~~ → assess

Mini ejercicio

Escribe el sustantivo de la palabra entre paréntesis.
Write the noun form of the word in brackets.

1. The _____ of the bridge took two years. (construct)
2. Her _____ to the project was vital. (contribute)
3. The _____ of the data took weeks. (analyse)
4. Nobody doubts the _____ of the plan. (feasible)
5. We underestimated the _____ of the task. (complex)

Explicación · Explanation

Lee cada recuadro despacio. Primero en español, luego en inglés. Read each box slowly: first in Spanish, then in English.

¿Qué es? · What is it?

🇪🇸 La **nominalización** consiste en expresar como **sustantivo** lo que normalmente diríamos con un verbo o un adjetivo: analyse → analysis, fail → failure, accurate → accuracy. Cuando convertimos una oración entera en una **frase nominal** (because prices rose → owing to the rise in prices), el texto se vuelve más **denso**, más **impersonal** y más **abstracto**: es el sello del inglés académico, jurídico, científico y de la prensa de calidad. En español ocurre lo mismo («tras la aprobación de la ley»), pero los sufijos, las colocaciones y las preposiciones del inglés son otros, y ahí está la dificultad.

🇬🇧 **Nominalisation** means expressing actions and qualities as **nouns**. Turning clauses into noun phrases makes writing denser, more impersonal and more abstract: the hallmark of academic, legal and scientific English.

Sustantivo = verbo / adjetivo + sufijo

the + sustantivo + of + complemento

1 · De verbo a sustantivo · Verb → noun

🇪🇸 La mayoría de los verbos forman su sustantivo con un sufijo. Los más productivos son **-tion/-sion** (reduce → reduction, decide → decision), **-ment** (achieve → achievement), **-ance/-ence** (comply → compliance, refer → reference), **-al** (refuse → refusal, approve → approval), **-ure** (fail → failure, disclose → disclosure) y **-sis**, de origen griego (analyse → analysis, emphasise → emphasis). Ojo: el sufijo **no es predecible** y a menudo no coincide con el español; hay que aprender cada sustantivo (refusal, nunca ~~refusement~~).

🇬🇧 Most verbs take a suffix: -tion/-sion, -ment, -ance/-ence, -al, -ure, -sis. The suffix is **not predictable**, so learn each noun individually.

reduction = reduce + -tion

refusal = refuse + -al

🌍 The **reduction** of emissions is a global priority.
→ La reducción de las emisiones es una prioridad mundial.

😶 Her **refusal** to comment fuelled speculation.
→ Su negativa a hacer declaraciones alimentó las especulaciones.

🗣️ The **failure** of the talks surprised nobody.
→ El fracaso de las negociaciones no sorprendió a nadie.

2 · De adjetivo a sustantivo · Adjective → noun

Las cualidades también se convierten en sustantivos abstractos: **-ity** (complex → complexity, scarce → scarcity, feasible → feasibility), **-ness** (aware → awareness, effective → effectiveness), **-ance/-ence** (relevant → relevance, reluctant → reluctance), **-cy** (accurate → accuracy, efficient → efficiency) y **-th**, con cambio vocálico (long → length, strong → strength, wide → width, deep → depth, true → truth). Al nominalizar, el adverbio que modificaba al adjetivo pasa a ser adjetivo: extremely complex → **extreme complexity**.

Qualities become abstract nouns: -ity, -ness, -ance/-ence, -cy, -th. Any adverb becomes an adjective: extremely complex → extreme complexity.

complexity = complex + -ity

extreme + complexity

The **complexity** of the task was underestimated.
→ Se subestimó la complejidad de la tarea.

There is growing **awareness** of the risks.
→ Hay una conciencia cada vez mayor de los riesgos.

The **length** of the report discouraged many readers.
→ La extensión del informe desanimó a muchos lectores.

3 · Conversión: misma forma, otro acento · Conversion (zero derivation)

Muchos verbos funcionan también como sustantivo **sin cambiar de forma**: increase, decrease, decline, rise, fall, change, review, demand, delay, report, release. En prosa formal se combinan con un adjetivo y una **preposición fija**: **a sharp rise in**, **a steady decline in**, **a thorough review of**. En varios bisílabos cambia el acento: el verbo lo lleva en la 2.ª sílaba (to inCREASE, to reCORD, to imPORT) y el sustantivo en la 1.ª (an INcrease, a REcord, an IMport).

Many verbs are also nouns with no change: increase, decline, review. Typical pattern: adjective + noun + fixed preposition (a sharp rise in). Two-syllable pairs often shift stress: to inCREASE / an INcrease.

a + adjective + noun + in / of

a + sharp rise + in + prices

There has been a **sharp rise in** energy prices.
→ Ha habido una fuerte subida de los precios de la energía.

The board ordered a thorough **review of** safety procedures.
→ La junta ordenó una revisión exhaustiva de los procedimientos de seguridad.

The **decline in** birth rates is reshaping Europe.
→ El descenso de la natalidad está transformando Europa.

4 · De oración a frase nominal · From clause to noun phrase

Este es el paso clave del estilo académico. Para condensar una oración en una frase nominal: (1) el **verbo** se convierte en sustantivo; (2) el **adverbio** pasa a adjetivo; (3) el **sujeto** pasa a genitivo (the government's), a frase con **of/by** o a adjetivo (economic); (4) el **objeto** va con **of**; (5) la **conjunción** se sustituye por una **preposición**: because → owing to, although → despite, after → following, when → upon. Resultado: una sola oración principal que contiene mucha más información.

To condense a clause: verb → noun, adverb → adjective, subject → possessive / of-phrase / adjective, object → of + noun, conjunction → preposition.

because + the economy grew rapidly

owing to + the rapid growth of the economy

owing to + rapid economic growth

Owing to rapid economic growth, unemployment fell.
→ Debido al rápido crecimiento económico, el paro descendió.

Following the minister's resignation, the party collapsed in the polls.
→ Tras la dimisión del ministro, el partido se hundió en las encuestas.

Despite the scarcity of evidence, the theory gained acceptance.
→ Pese a la escasez de pruebas, la teoría fue ganando aceptación.

5 · Verbos que encadenan sustantivos · Verbs that link noun phrases

Una vez nominalizadas las ideas, las unimos con verbos de **causa-efecto**. Fíjate en la **dirección**: CAUSA **leads to / results in / gives rise to / brings about / contributes to / triggers** EFECTO, pero EFECTO **results from / stems from / arises from / is attributable to** CAUSA. Result in y result from significan lo contrario: es un error frecuentísimo incluso en niveles altos. Con estos verbos la lógica del texto queda clarísima: A → B en una sola cláusula.

Link nominalised ideas with cause-effect verbs. CAUSE leads to / results in / gives rise to EFFECT; EFFECT results from / stems from / arises from CAUSE.

CAUSA + lead to / result in / give rise to + EFECTO

EFECTO + result from / stem from / arise from + CAUSA

The deregulation of the market **led to** a surge in speculation.
→ La desregulación del mercado provocó un auge de la especulación.

The findings **gave rise to** serious concerns about safety.
→ Los resultados suscitaron una seria preocupación por la seguridad.

Most of these problems **stem from** a lack of communication.
→ La mayoría de estos problemas se deben a la falta de comunicación.

NOMINALIZACIÓN

Nominalisation · estilo académico

📖 Explicación · Explanation | Nivel C2

Mapa de sufijos · Suffix map

Sufijo · Suffix	Base	Sustantivo · Noun	En contexto · In context
-tion / -sion	reduce, decide, permit	reduction, decision, permission	a **reduction** in costs
-ment	achieve, assess, require	achievement, assessment, requirement	an **assessment** of the risks
-ance / -ence	comply, refer, emerge	compliance, reference, emergence	**compliance** with the law
-al	refuse, approve, withdraw	refusal, approval, withdrawal	the **withdrawal** of troops
-ure	fail, disclose, expend	failure, disclosure, expenditure	public **expenditure** on health
-sis	analyse, emphasise, hypothesise	analysis, emphasis, hypothesis	the **emphasis** on exams
-ity / -cy	scarce, feasible, accurate	scarcity, feasibility, accuracy	the **scarcity** of water
-ness	aware, willing, effective	awareness, willingness, effectiveness	a **willingness** to negotiate
-th	long, strong, grow	length, strength, growth	economic **growth**
Ø (conversión)	increase, decline, review	an increase, a decline, a review	a sharp **decline** in sales

Plurales griegos: **analysis → analyses**, **hypothesis → hypotheses**, **crisis → crises**, **basis → bases**. Y hay sustantivos irregulares que conviene memorizar: deny → denial, die → death, choose → choice, prove → proof, believe → belief.

Greek plurals: analyses, hypotheses, crises, bases. Some nouns are irregular: denial, death, choice, proof, belief.

Conectores: de conjunción a preposición · Linkers: conjunction → preposition

Relación · Meaning	Con oración (informal)	Con sustantivo (formal)	Ejemplo · Example
Causa	because, as, since	**owing to, due to, in view of, on account of**	**In view of** the costs, the plan was dropped.
Concesión	although, even though	**despite, in spite of, notwithstanding**	**Despite** its flaws, the study is valuable.
Tiempo (después)	after, once	**following, after, subsequent to**	**Following** the merger, 300 jobs were cut.
Tiempo (antes)	before	**prior to, before**	**Prior to** publication, the data were checked.

Conectores: de conjunción a preposición · Linkers: conjunction → preposition (continúa · cont.)

Relación · Meaning	Con oración (informal)	Con sustantivo (formal)	Ejemplo · Example
Tiempo (al…)	when, as soon as	upon, on	Upon arrival, delegates must register.
Condición	if, unless	in the event of, in the absence of	In the event of fire, use the stairs.
Finalidad	so that, in order to	with a view to, for the purpose of	talks with a view to a ceasefire
Contraste	whereas, while	in contrast to, as opposed to	In contrast to its rivals, the firm grew.

Due to se usa tradicionalmente tras be (The delay was due to the strike); a principio de frase el registro esmerado prefiere owing to. Si necesitas una oración completa tras la preposición, añade the fact that: owing to the fact that…, despite the fact that…

Traditionally due to follows be; owing to is preferred at the start of a sentence. Need a full clause? Add the fact that.

Registro: ¿cuándo NO nominalizar? · Register: when not to nominalise

La nominalización es propia de artículos científicos, informes, textos jurídicos y prensa de calidad. En correos, presentaciones orales o textos divulgativos, el exceso suena pomposo u opaco: la especialista en escritura académica Helen Sword llama a estos sustantivos vacíos zombie nouns. Regla práctica: nominaliza para empaquetar un concepto que vas a retomar (this reduction…, such a decline…), no para esconder quién hizo qué. Y no sustituyas un verbo claro por make + sustantivo sin motivo: ~~make an assessment of~~ → assess.

Nominalise to package a concept you will build on, not to hide who did what. In emails and speech, prefer verbs and avoid 'zombie nouns'.

6 · La frase nominal compleja · Building complex noun phrases

El inglés académico acumula información **antes** del sustantivo (premodificación: a **rapid** increase, **government** policy, **long-term** unemployment) y **después** (posmodificación con of, in, for… o con una relativa). Dos consejos: (1) cuando el modificador es breve, prefiere el genitivo o un sustantivo en función de adjetivo a las cadenas de of: ~~the impact of the reform of the system of pensions~~ → **the impact of pension reform**; (2) no amontones más de tres sustantivos seguidos: the student housing allocation policy review resulta opaco.

Pack information before the noun (adjectives, noun modifiers) and after it (prepositional phrases). Avoid long chains of **of** and stacks of more than three nouns.

rapid + population + growth + in urban areas

premodificador + núcleo + posmodificador

☀️ **The rapid expansion of renewable energy** has cut emissions.
→ La rápida expansión de las energías renovables ha reducido las emisiones.

💼 **Long-term unemployment** remains a serious problem.
→ El paro de larga duración sigue siendo un grave problema.

👴 **The impact of pension reform** on young workers is unclear.
→ No está claro el impacto de la reforma de las pensiones en los trabajadores jóvenes.

Estilo verbal frente a estilo nominal · Verbal vs nominal style

Mismo contenido, dos registros. El estilo verbal es más directo y fácil de leer; el nominal es más compacto e impersonal, propio de informes, artículos y textos jurídicos.

Same content, two registers: verbal style is direct; nominal style is compact and impersonal.

🗣️ Verbal · informal

- Prices went up sharply, so people bought less.
- We analysed the data and found that…
- Because the climate is changing, crops are failing.
- If someone breaks the contract, …
- People criticised how the government handled the crisis.

🎓 Nominal · académico

- The sharp **rise in prices** led to a **fall in consumption**.
- **Analysis of the data** revealed that…
- **Climate change** is resulting in **crop failure**.
- **In the event of a breach of contract**, …
- **The government's handling of the crisis** was criticised.

Colocaciones formales verbo + sustantivo · Formal verb + noun collocations

🕵️ carry out an investigation llevar a cabo una investigación	🔬 conduct research realizar una investigación	🏁 reach a conclusion llegar a una conclusión	🎁 make a contribution hacer una aportación
⚠️ pose a threat suponer una amenaza	⚖️ draw a distinction establecer una distinción	😟 give rise to concern suscitar preocupación	🧮 take into account tener en cuenta

Colocaciones formales verbo + sustantivo · Formal verb + noun collocations (continúa · cont.)

raise awareness concienciar, sensibilizar	place emphasis on hacer hincapié en	gain insight into comprender a fondo	exert pressure on ejercer presión sobre
undergo a transformation experimentar una transformación	bear responsibility asumir la responsabilidad	meet the requirements cumplir los requisitos	draw attention to llamar la atención sobre

Un texto, dos versiones: densidad léxica · One text, two versions: lexical density

La densidad léxica es la proporción de palabras con contenido (sustantivos, verbos léxicos, adjetivos y adverbios) respecto al total. La versión académica dice lo mismo con menos palabras, menos verbos conjugados y más sustantivos: cada frase nominal «empaqueta» una oración entera.

Lexical density = content words ÷ total words. The academic version says the same with fewer words, fewer finite verbs and more nouns.

Versión oral · 45 palabras · 8 verbos conjugados

- Because the government decided to put up the tax on fuel, people started to drive less, so the companies that make cars lost a lot of money. When they realised what was happening, many of them decided that they would invest in electric cars instead.

Versión académica · 32 palabras · 2 verbos conjugados

- The government's decision to raise fuel duty led to a marked reduction in car use and, consequently, to substantial losses for vehicle manufacturers. In response, many firms redirected investment towards electric vehicles.

Más ejemplos · More examples

- The introduction of tuition fees resulted in a decline in applications.
  → La introducción de las tasas universitarias provocó un descenso de las solicitudes.
- In view of the urgency of the situation, the summit was brought forward.
  → Dada la urgencia de la situación, se adelantó la cumbre.
- The committee reached the conclusion that the scheme was unviable.
  → El comité llegó a la conclusión de que el plan era inviable.
- Prior to the adoption of the new constitution, power was highly centralised.
  → Antes de la aprobación de la nueva constitución, el poder estaba muy centralizado.

Más ejemplos · More examples (continúa · cont.)

- There is a clear correlation between poverty and poor health.
  → Existe una clara correlación entre la pobreza y la mala salud.
- The disappearance of local shops poses a threat to community life.
  → La desaparición del comercio local supone una amenaza para la vida comunitaria.
- Upon completion of the course, participants receive a certificate.
  → Al finalizar el curso, los participantes reciben un certificado.

Más ejemplos · More examples (continúa · cont.)

- The **scarcity** of affordable housing is **attributable to** decades of underinvestment.
  → La escasez de vivienda asequible se debe a décadas de inversión insuficiente.
- Her **insistence on** transparency earned her the respect of her colleagues.
  → Su insistencia en la transparencia le valió el respeto de sus colegas.
- **Failure to comply** with these regulations may **result in** a fine.
  → El incumplimiento de esta normativa puede acarrear una multa.
- The **proliferation** of fake news **has given rise to** widespread distrust of the media.
  → La proliferación de noticias falsas ha generado una desconfianza generalizada hacia los medios.
- **Acceptance** of the proposal is conditional on the board's **approval**.
  → La aceptación de la propuesta está supeditada a la aprobación de la junta.

¡Caza al monstruo! · Hunt the monster

Monstruo del error

✗ ~~The researchers realised a study.~~
✓ The researchers **carried out** (**conducted**) a study.
«Realizar un estudio» no es realise (= darse cuenta). Usa **carry out, conduct, undertake.** / Realise = become aware. Use carry out / conduct / undertake.

✗ ~~a sharp increasement in costs~~
✓ a sharp **increase** in costs
~~increasement~~ no existe: increase es verbo y sustantivo (conversión). Igual: refusal, no ~~refusement~~. / Increase is both verb and noun. Likewise refusal, not refusement.

✗ ~~The education is the key to the progress.~~
✓ **Education** is the key to **progress**.
Los sustantivos abstractos en sentido general van **sin artículo**: society, education, technology, progress. / Abstract nouns used in a general sense take no article.

✗ ~~the government's decision of raising taxes~~
✓ the government's decision **to raise** taxes
El sustantivo hereda el complemento del verbo: decide **to** → decision **to**; refuse to → refusal to; fail to → failure to. / Nouns keep their verb's pattern: decision / refusal / failure + to-infinitive.

✗ ~~Owing to the economy grew, unemployment fell.~~
✓ **Owing to economic growth**, unemployment fell.
Owing to, due to, despite, following son preposiciones: van con sustantivo, no con oración (o bien con the fact that). / These are prepositions: noun phrase, not clause.

✗ ~~Smoking can result from lung cancer.~~
✓ Smoking can **result in** lung cancer.
result in = provocar (causa → efecto); **result from** = deberse a (efecto ← causa). / result in = cause; result from = be caused by.



¡Caza al monstruo! · Hunt the monster (cont.)

Monstruo del error

✗ ~~a sharp raise in prices~~

✓ a sharp **rise** in prices

El sustantivo de «subida» es rise (de rise, intransitivo); raise es transitivo: to raise prices. En BrE: a pay rise. / A rise in prices; to raise prices; BrE a pay rise.

✗ ~~The making of a decision on the implementation of the plan was carried out by the board.~~

✓ The board **decided to implement** the plan.

Sobrenominalización (zombie nouns): si la frase nominal no aporta nada, vuelve al verbo. / Over-nominalisation: use the verb when nouns add nothing.

¿Cómo nominalizo una frase? · How do I nominalise a sentence?

1. Localiza el **verbo** o el **adjetivo** que expresa la idea clave: The economy grew rapidly because exports increased.
   Find the key verb or adjective.
2. Busca su **sustantivo** (sufijo o conversión) y comprueba que existe: grow → **growth**, increase → **increase**.
   Find the noun form and check that it exists.
3. Convierte el **adverbio en adjetivo** y el sujeto/objeto en genitivo, frase con of o modificador: rapid economic growth, an increase in exports.
   Adverb → adjective; subject/object → possessive, of-phrase or modifier.
4. Sustituye la **conjunción** por una preposición (because → owing to) o enlaza con un **verbo de causa-efecto** (lead to, result in).
   Replace the conjunction with a preposition or a cause-effect verb.
5. Ensambla la frase: **An increase in exports led to rapid economic growth.**
   Assemble: An increase in exports led to rapid economic growth.
6. Relee: ¿se entiende mejor? ¿Se ha perdido quién hizo qué? Si no ganas nada, vuelve al verbo.
   Reread: is it clearer? If not, go back to the verb.

Ejercicios · Practice

Escribe con lápiz y letra clara. Antes de escribir, piensa qué regla toca. Write in pencil. Think about the rule first.

Name · Nombre _____ Date · Fecha _____ Score _____

Ejercicio 1 ¿Qué sufijo lleva? · Which suffix?

Escribe cada palabra en la caja del sufijo que forma su sustantivo. Después, escribe el sustantivo al lado.

Sort the words by the suffix their noun takes. Then write the noun next to each one.

Word bank: complex · resist · permit · stable · willing · assess · scarce · manage · enforce · require · emerge · appear · reduce · aware · decide · comply · compete · achieve · explain · depend

-tion / -sion	-ment	-ance / -ence	-ity / -ness

Ejercicio 2 Familias de palabras · Complete the word families

Escribe el sustantivo de cada verbo y de cada adjetivo. Cuidado con los irregulares y con los sufijos griegos.

Write the noun form of each verb and adjective.

Verbo · Verb	Sustantivo · Noun	Adjetivo · Adjective	Sustantivo · Noun
fail	_____	wide	_____
analyse	_____	strong	_____
propose	_____	accurate	_____

Ejercicio 2 Familias de palabras · Complete the word families (continúa · cont.)

Verbo · Verb	Sustantivo · Noun	Adjetivo · Adjective	Sustantivo · Noun
emphasise	_____	relevant	_____
disclose	_____	reluctant	_____
deny	_____	vague	_____
hypothesise	_____	feasible	_____
withdraw	_____	deep	_____
comply	_____	precise	_____
expand	_____	true	_____

Ejercicio 3 Elige la forma correcta · Choose the correct form

✍️ Rodea la opción correcta: sustantivo bien formado, preposición adecuada o conector correcto.
🇬🇧 Circle the correct option.

1. The analyse / analysis / analysation of the samples took three weeks.
2. There has been a sharp increase / increasement / increasing in rents.
3. The minister's refusal / refusement / refuse to resign angered voters.
4. The deepness / depth / deepth of the crisis was underestimated.

Ejercicio 3 Elige la forma correcta · Choose the correct form (continúa · cont.)

5. The arrive / arrival / arrivement of the new CEO changed the company's culture.
6. Last year there was a rise in / of unemployment.
7. Sales rose by 5 %: there was a rise in / of 5 % in sales.
8. Despite / Although the lack of funding, the project succeeded.
9. A poor diet can result in / result from serious illness.
10. These problems stem from / lead to decades of neglect.

Ejercicio 4 — De conjunción a preposición · Conjunction → preposition

Une cada conjunción (estilo verbal) con la preposición equivalente que se usa con sustantivos (estilo nominal).
Match each conjunction with its prepositional equivalent.

1 because (+ clause)	a in the event of
2 although	b with a view to
3 after	c upon
4 before	d following
5 if	e despite
6 as soon as / when	f in contrast to
7 so that / in order to	g prior to
8 whereas	h owing to (+ noun)

Ejercicio 5 — Sustantivo + preposición · Noun + preposition

Completa con la preposición que acompaña al sustantivo.
Complete with the preposition that follows the noun.

1. There has been a steady increase _____ the number of applicants.
2. Nobody has yet found a solution _____ the problem of congestion.
3. The main cause _____ the accident was human error.
4. There is a growing demand _____ affordable housing.
5. The new law will have a significant impact _____ small businesses.

Ejercicio 5 — Sustantivo + preposición · Noun + preposition (continúa · cont.)

6. The report offers a fascinating insight _____ the workings of government.
7. Lack _____ sleep impairs concentration.
8. The reason _____ the delay has not been disclosed.
9. Universal access _____ clean water remains a distant goal.
10. The inquiry shed new light _____ the causes of the incident.
11. Climate change poses a serious threat _____ biodiversity.
12. The school places great emphasis _____ critical thinking.

Ejercicio 6 — Colocaciones formales · Formal collocations

Completa con un verbo del recuadro en la forma correcta. Usa cada verbo una vez.
Complete with a verb from the box in the correct form. Use each verb once.

Word bank: reach · pose · draw · make · carry out · give · take · raise · place · undergo

1. After three days of deliberation, the jury finally _____ a verdict.
2. Rising sea levels _____ a serious threat to coastal cities.
3. In her essay, the author _____ a clear distinction between guilt and shame.

Ejercicio 6 — Colocaciones formales · Formal collocations (continúa · cont.)

4 Immigrants _____ a significant contribution to the economy.

5 The police are _____ a thorough investigation into the fire.

6 The new measures could _____ rise to further unrest.

7 The report fails to _____ into account regional differences.

8 The campaign aims to _____ awareness of mental health issues.

9 The new curriculum _____ great emphasis on critical thinking.

10 Since 2000, the city has _____ a radical transformation.

Ejercicio 7 — ¿Verdadero o falso? · True or false?

Lee cada afirmación sobre la nominalización y marca T (verdadero) o F (falso).
Tick T (true) or F (false).

1 The increasement of prices is correct in formal English. T F

2 The plural of analysis is analyses. T F

3 Make an investigation is the most natural collocation in academic English. T F

4 Owing to is followed by a noun phrase, not by a full clause. T F

5 X results in Y and Y results from X express the same relationship. T F

Ejercicio 7 — ¿Verdadero o falso? · True or false? (continúa · cont.)

6 Nominalisation always makes a text clearer. T F

7 In the rapid growth of the economy, the adverb rapidly has become an adjective. T F

8 The noun from deny is denegation. T F

9 Decline, review and increase can be used as nouns without a suffix. T F

10 In to inCREASE / an INcrease, the noun is stressed on the first syllable. T F

Ejercicio 8 — Ordena la frase académica · Build the academic sentence

Ordena los bloques para formar una frase de estilo nominal. Añade mayúscula, coma si hace falta y punto final.
Put the blocks in order to make a sentence in nominal style.

1 led to | the closure | rising costs | of the factory

2 owing to | the match | was postponed | heavy rain

3 a significant contribution | to | made | the study | the field

Ejercicio 8 — Ordena la frase académica · Build the academic sentence (continúa · cont.)

4 the implementation | of | was delayed | the new policy

5 the government's | to raise taxes | decision | widespread criticism | provoked

6 gave rise to | concern | the findings | among | considerable | experts

7 despite | of | the lack | the project | funding | succeeded

8 upon | the minister | the report | of | publication | resigned

9 in view of | the scheme | its limited | was abandoned | impact

10 stem from | these problems | a failure | communicate | to

Ejercicio 9 — Del verbo al sustantivo · From verb to noun

✍️ Reescribe la frase empezando como se indica. Convierte la palabra subrayada en sustantivo.

🇬🇧 Rewrite the sentence starting as shown. Turn the underlined word into a noun.

1 The economy grew rapidly in the 1990s.
→ The 1990s saw …

2 The government failed to act, and the public was outraged.
→ The government's …

3 The bridge was closed, so traffic was chaotic.
→ The closure …

4 If the system fails, the backup generator will start.
→ In the event …

5 After the minister resigned, the party was in crisis.
→ Following …

6 Although the evidence is weak, many people believe the theory.
→ Despite …

Ejercicio 9 — Del verbo al sustantivo · From verb to noun (continúa · cont.)

7 Researchers discovered penicillin, and this revolutionised medicine.
→ The discovery …

8 It is essential that the data are accurate.
→ The accuracy …

Ejercicio 10 — Corrige el error · Correct the mistake

✍️ Cada frase tiene UN error típico de hispanohablantes de nivel avanzado. Reescríbela correctamente.
🇬🇧 Each sentence has ONE mistake. Write it correctly.

1 ✗ The researchers realised a study of 500 patients.
✓

2 ✗ There has been a dramatic increasement in rents.
✓

3 ✗ The government's decision of raising taxes was unpopular.
✓

4 ✗ Technological advances have transformed the society.
✓

Ejercicio 10 — Corrige el error · Correct the mistake (continúa · cont.)

5 ✗ Several analysis were carried out before the trial.
✓

6 ✗ Owing to the economy grew, unemployment fell.
✓

7 ✗ Despite of the high cost, the project went ahead.
✓

8 ✗ Last year there was a sharp rise of unemployment.
✓

9 ✗ Smoking can result from lung cancer.
✓

10 ✗ Her refusement to cooperate surprised everyone.
✓

Ejercicio 11 Informal → académico · Informal → academic

✍️ Reescribe en estilo académico usando nominalización y las palabras entre paréntesis. El solucionario ofrece una versión modelo; puede haber otras correctas.
🇬🇧 Rewrite in academic style, using nominalisation and the words in brackets. Model answers are given.

1. Lots of people are worried because crime has gone up. (concern · rise)

2. We looked at the results and saw that the drug didn't work very well. (analysis · effectiveness)

3. Prices went up a lot, so people bought much less. (rise · lead to)

4. If we don't invest in schools, things will just get worse. (failure · result in)

5. The company changed the way it was organised, and the workers weren't happy about it. (restructuring · dissatisfaction)

6. Scientists still don't agree about why bees are disappearing. (consensus · decline)

7. Because the government reacted so slowly, the virus spread really fast. (response · spread)

8. When the results were published, everyone started arguing about them. (publication · debate)

Ejercicio 12 Transformaciones con palabra clave · Key word transformations

✍️ Completa la segunda frase para que signifique lo mismo que la primera. Usa la palabra clave sin cambiarla y entre 3 y 8 palabras (estilo Cambridge C2 Proficiency, Part 4).
🇬🇧 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the key word unchanged and 3–8 words.

1. The factory closed because demand had fallen sharply.
   → The closure of the factory _____ in demand. (DUE)

2. The report didn't mention the risks at all.
   → The report made _____ the risks. (REFERENCE)

3. They decided to postpone the launch, which surprised everyone.
   → Everyone was surprised _____ the launch. (DECISION)

4. She contributed enormously to the success of the project.
   → She made _____ the success of the project. (CONTRIBUTION)

Ejercicio 12 — Transformaciones con palabra clave · Key word transformations (continúa · cont.)

5 The new law will probably affect small businesses considerably.
→ The new law is likely _____ small businesses. (IMPACT)

6 Nobody has explained satisfactorily why the system failed.
→ No satisfactory _____ the failure of the system. (GIVEN)

7 The minister denied all knowledge of the affair, but few people believed her.
→ Few people _____ all knowledge of the affair. (DENIAL)

8 They investigated the accident thoroughly.
→ A thorough _____ the accident. (CARRIED)

Ejercicio 13 — Traduce al inglés · Translate into English

Traduce con estilo nominal. Cuidado con los calcos (realizar, la sociedad, debido a…).
Translate into English using nominal style.

1 La construcción del nuevo hospital se retrasó debido a la falta de financiación.

2 Los investigadores llevaron a cabo un análisis exhaustivo de los datos.

3 El aumento del desempleo ha provocado un malestar generalizado.

4 Tras la publicación del informe, el ministro dimitió.

5 Es preciso establecer una distinción entre ambos conceptos.

6 La subida de los tipos de interés dio lugar a una caída de la demanda.

7 Pese a la complejidad del problema, llegaron a una conclusión en pocas horas.

Ejercicio 13 — Traduce al inglés · Translate into English

(continúa · cont.)

8 La sociedad exige una mayor transparencia en la gestión de los fondos públicos.

9 En caso de incumplimiento del contrato, la empresa será sancionada.

10 Su negativa a colaborar supone una amenaza para el proyecto.

Ejercicio 14 Lee y contesta · Read and answer

✍️ Lee el artículo. Marca T (verdadero) o F (falso) y contesta las preguntas.
🇬🇧 Read the article. Tick T or F and answer the questions.

The noun habit

Anyone who has read a scientific journal will have noticed a peculiar feature of academic prose: its fondness for nouns. Where a journalist might write that scientists tested the vaccine and found that it worked, a researcher is more likely to report the evaluation of the vaccine's efficacy. The linguist M.A.K. Halliday described this shift from verbs to nouns as a form of grammatical metaphor: processes and qualities are repackaged as things.

The advantages are considerable. Nominalisation allows writers to compress a great deal of information into a single phrase, to present an earlier argument as a given (this reduction, such a decline) and to build long chains of reasoning in which one noun phrase becomes the subject of the next sentence. It also lends prose an air of objectivity, since the people who performed the actions tend to disappear.

That disappearance, however, is precisely what worries critics. The writing scholar Helen Sword has called excessive nominalisations zombie nouns because they suck the life out of sentences: the implementation of the reorganisation of the department is far harder to process than they reorganised the department. Strings of abstract nouns can also conceal responsibility, as in mistakes were made in the allocation of funds. Good academic writers, then, nominalise selectively: when a noun phrase packages a key concept, they use it; when it merely obscures who did what, they return to a verb.

1. According to the text, journalists use more nouns than researchers. T F
2. Halliday regarded nominalisation as a type of grammatical metaphor. T F
3. Nominalisation makes it easier to identify who performed an action. T F
4. Helen Sword recommends avoiding nouns altogether. T F
5. Give two advantages of nominalisation mentioned in the text.

6. Why are excessive nominalisations called zombie nouns?

Ejercicio 14 **Lee y contesta** · Read and answer (continúa · cont.)

7 Which noun phrase in paragraph 1 corresponds to tested the vaccine and found that it worked?

8 Rewrite mistakes were made in the allocation of funds with an active verb and a clear agent.

9 According to the last paragraph, when do good writers return to a verb?

Ejercicio 15 **Ahora escribe tú** · Your turn

✍️ Escribe en estilo académico. Usa nominalizaciones, colocaciones formales y verbos de causa-efecto.
🇬🇧 Write in academic style using nominalisation.

1 Reescribe en estilo académico (máx. 35 palabras): «Because lots of tourists come to the city, rents have gone up and local people can't afford to live in the centre any more.»

2 Escribe dos frases sobre un problema de tu ciudad: una con **lead to / result in** y otra con **stem from**.

Ejercicio 15 **Ahora escribe tú** · Your turn (continúa · cont.)

3 Escribe una frase con **owing to**, otra con **despite** y otra con **upon** + sustantivo.

4 Escribe un breve abstract (40–60 palabras) de un estudio imaginario con al menos cinco nominalizaciones y dos colocaciones formales (carry out, reach…).

¿Lo he aprendido? · Can I do it?

Marca cada frase cuando la sepas hacer y colorea las estrellas. Tick each line when you can do it and colour the stars.

Lo sé hacer · I can...

- [ ] Formo el sustantivo correcto de verbos y adjetivos (**refusal, failure, scarcity, width**). ☆☆☆
  I can form the correct noun from verbs and adjectives.
- [ ] Transformo una oración en **frase nominal**: verbo → sustantivo, adverbio → adjetivo. ☆☆☆
  I can turn a clause into a noun phrase.
- [ ] Sustituyo conjunciones por preposiciones: **owing to, despite, following, upon**. ☆☆☆
  I can replace conjunctions with prepositions.
- [ ] Uso bien **lead to / result in / stem from** sin confundir la dirección causa-efecto. ☆☆☆
  I use cause-effect verbs in the right direction.
- [ ] Domino colocaciones formales: **carry out, conduct, reach, pose, draw**. ☆☆☆
  I know formal collocations such as carry out an investigation.
- [ ] Sé cuándo NO nominalizar y evito los zombie nouns. ☆☆☆
  I know when not to nominalise and avoid zombie nouns.

Mi progreso · My progress

Colorea 1, 2 o 3 estrellas en cada ejercicio. Colour 1, 2 or 3 stars for each exercise.

Ej. 1 ☆☆☆	Ej. 2 ☆☆☆	Ej. 3 ☆☆☆	Ej. 4 ☆☆☆
Ej. 5 ☆☆☆	Ej. 6 ☆☆☆	Ej. 7 ☆☆☆	Ej. 8 ☆☆☆
Ej. 9 ☆☆☆	Ej. 10 ☆☆☆	Ej. 11 ☆☆☆	Ej. 12 ☆☆☆
Ej. 13 ☆☆☆	Ej. 14 ☆☆☆	Ej. 15 ☆☆☆	

Solucionario · Answer key

Para el adulto que corrige (¡o para comprobar después de hacerlo!). For the grown-up who checks, or to check after you finish.

Mapa · Mini ejercicio

1. construction · 2. contribution · 3. analysis · 4. feasibility · 5. complexity

Ejercicio 1 · ¿Qué sufijo lleva?

-tion / -sion: decide, reduce, explain, compete, permit
-ment: achieve, assess, manage, require, enforce
-ance / -ence: resist, depend, appear, emerge, comply
-ity / -ness: scarce, aware, complex, willing, stable

Ejercicio 2 · Familias de palabras

Verbo · Verb	Sustantivo · Noun	Adjetivo · Adjective	Sustantivo · Noun
fail	failure	wide	width
analyse	analysis	strong	strength
propose	proposal	accurate	accuracy
emphasise	emphasis	relevant	relevance
disclose	disclosure	reluctant	reluctance
deny	denial	vague	vagueness
hypothesise	hypothesis	feasible	feasibility
withdraw	withdrawal	deep	depth
comply	compliance	precise	precision
expand	expansion	true	truth

Ejercicio 3 · Elige la forma correcta

1. analysis · 2. increase · 3. refusal · 4. depth · 5. arrival · 6. in · 7. of · 8. Despite

Ejercicio 3 · Elige la forma correcta (continúa · cont.)

9. result in · 10. stem from

Ejercicio 4 · De conjunción a preposición

1-h · 2-e · 3-d · 4-g · 5-a · 6-c · 7-b · 8-f

Ejercicio 5 · Sustantivo + preposición

1. in · 2. to · 3. of · 4. for · 5. on / upon · 6. into · 7. of · 8. for · 9. to · 10. on · 11. to · 12. on / upon

Ejercicio 6 · Colocaciones formales

1. reached · 2. pose · 3. draws / makes · 4. make · 5. carrying out · 6. give · 7. take · 8. raise · 9. places · 10. undergone

Ejercicio 7 · ¿Verdadero o falso?

1. False ✗ — The noun is **increase**: the increase in prices.
2. True ✓
3. False ✗ — Use **carry out / conduct** an investigation.
4. True ✓ — owing to + noun / owing to the fact that + clause.
5. True ✓
6. False ✗ — Overuse creates zombie nouns and hides who did what.
7. True ✓
8. False ✗ — It is **denial**.
9. True ✓
10. True ✓

Ejercicio 8 · Ordena la frase académica

1. Rising costs led to the closure of the factory.
2. The match was postponed owing to heavy rain.
3. The study made a significant contribution to the field.
4. The implementation of the new policy was delayed.
5. The government's decision to raise taxes provoked widespread criticism.
6. The findings gave rise to considerable concern among experts.
7. Despite the lack of funding, the project succeeded.
8. Upon publication of the report, the minister resigned.
9. In view of its limited impact, the scheme was abandoned.
10. These problems stem from a failure to communicate.

Ejercicio 9 · Del verbo al sustantivo

1. The 1990s saw rapid economic growth. / The 1990s saw the rapid growth of the economy.
2. The government's failure to act caused (provoked / led to) public outrage.
3. The closure of the bridge led to (resulted in / caused) traffic chaos.
4. In the event of (a) system failure, the backup generator will start.
5. Following the minister's resignation (the resignation of the minister), the party was in crisis.
6. Despite the weakness of the evidence, many people believe the theory.
7. The discovery of penicillin revolutionised medicine.
8. The accuracy of the data is essential.

Ejercicio 10 · Corrige el error

1. The researchers carried out a study of 500 patients. / The researchers conducted a study of 500 patients.
2. There has been a dramatic increase in rents.
3. The government's decision to raise taxes was unpopular.
4. Technological advances have transformed society.
5. Several analyses were carried out before the trial.
6. Owing to economic growth, unemployment fell. / Because the economy grew, unemployment fell.

Ejercicio 10 · Corrige el error (continúa · cont.)

7. Despite the high cost, the project went ahead. / In spite of the high cost, the project went ahead.
8. Last year there was a sharp rise in unemployment.
9. Smoking can result in lung cancer.
10. Her refusal to cooperate surprised everyone.

Ejercicio 11 · Informal → académico

1. The rise in crime has caused widespread concern. / There is widespread concern about the rise in crime.
2. Analysis of the results revealed the limited effectiveness of the drug.
3. The sharp rise in prices led to a significant fall in consumption.
4. Failure to invest in education will result in a further decline in standards.
5. The restructuring of the company gave rise to dissatisfaction among its workforce.
6. There is still no scientific consensus on the causes of the decline in bee populations.
7. The government's slow response led to the rapid spread of the virus.
8. The publication of the results gave rise to intense debate. / Upon publication, the results sparked intense debate.

Ejercicio 12 · Transformaciones con palabra clave

1. The closure of the factory **was due to a sharp fall (drop / decline)** in demand.
2. The report made **no reference whatsoever (at all) to** the risks.
3. Everyone was surprised **by (at) their decision to postpone** the launch.
4. She made **an enormous contribution to** the success of the project.
5. The new law is likely **to have a considerable impact on** small businesses.
6. No satisfactory **explanation has been given for** the failure of the system.
7. Few people **believed the minister's denial of** all knowledge of the affair.
8. A thorough **investigation was carried out into** the accident.

NOMINALIZACIÓN

Nominalisation · estilo académico

Solucionario · Answer key

Nivel C2

Ejercicio 13 · Traduce al inglés

1. The construction of the new hospital was delayed owing to (due to) a lack of funding.
2. The researchers carried out (conducted) a thorough analysis of the data.
3. The rise in unemployment has caused (led to) widespread discontent.
4. Following (the) publication of the report, the minister resigned.
5. It is necessary to draw a distinction between the two concepts.
6. The rise in interest rates led to (resulted in) a fall in demand.
7. Despite the complexity of the problem, they reached a conclusion within a few hours.
8. Society demands greater transparency in the management of public funds.
9. In the event of a breach of contract, the company will be penalised.
10. Her (His) refusal to cooperate poses a threat to the project.

Ejercicio 14 · Lee y contesta

1. False ✗ — Researchers are more likely to use nominal style.
2. True ✓
3. False ✗ — The people who performed the actions tend to disappear.
4. False ✗ — She criticises excessive nominalisations, not nouns in general.
5. Any two: compressing information; presenting earlier arguments as given; building chains of reasoning; objectivity.
6. Because they suck the life out of sentences and make them harder to process.
7. the evaluation of the vaccine's efficacy
8. e.g. The committee allocated the funds incorrectly.
9. When a noun phrase merely obscures who did what.

Ejercicio 15 · Ahora escribe tú

1. Ej.: The massive influx of tourists into the city has led to a sharp rise in rents, which has priced many local residents out of the historic centre.
2. Ej.: The lack of reliable public transport inevitably leads to heavy traffic congestion in the city centre at peak times. Much of the air pollution stems from the widespread use of private cars.
3. Ej.: Owing to the strike, all flights were cancelled. Despite the heavy rain, the match went ahead as planned. Upon arrival, all guests receive a welcome pack and a map of the city.
4. Ej.: This study examines the impact of remote working on employee well-being. A survey was carried out among 1,200 workers. Analysis of the data revealed a significant reduction in stress but a marked increase in feelings of isolation, pointing to the need for a balanced approach to hybrid working.